

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2026**

Courses Audience: **44**

Responses Received: **44**

Response Ratio: **100 %**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

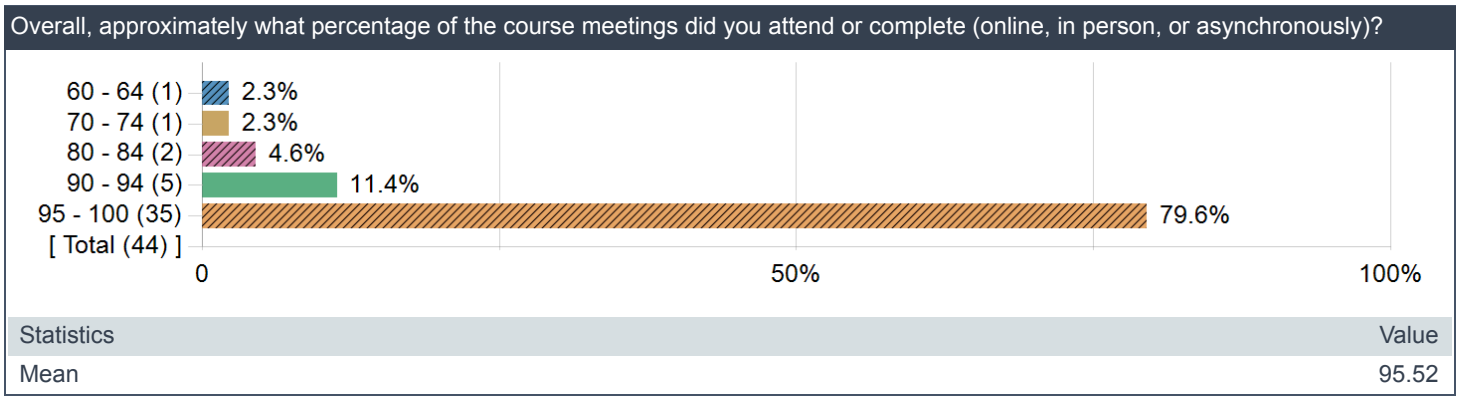
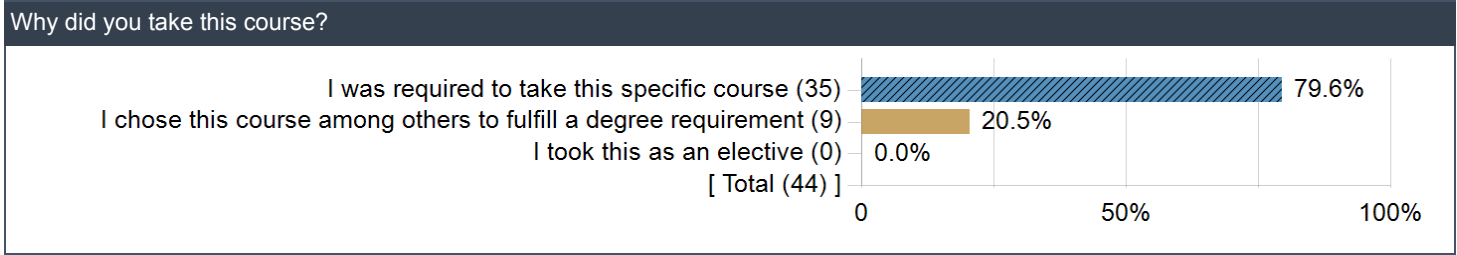
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	68.2%	25.0%	6.8%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.61
The course was well organized.	68.2%	22.7%	9.1%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.59
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	68.2%	25.0%	6.8%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.61
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	65.9%	25.0%	9.1%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.57
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	68.2%	27.3%	4.5%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.64
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	68.2%	25.0%	4.5%	2.3%	0.0%	44	4.59
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	63.6%	29.5%	6.8%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.57

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	77.3%	15.9%	6.8%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.70
Overall, this course was	59.1%	27.3%	13.6%	0.0%	0.0%	44	4.45

Other Course Questions





Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The homeworks that were assigned
– attending lectures – homeworks
I really enjoyed the homeworks. They allowed me to deeply learn the material and check my understanding.
The r studio practice that we would do each class period really helped me understand what we were learning each day. Professor Bolfarine makes complex topics easier by simplifying the language and going at a good pace so that everyone can pick up the material.
The in-class examples that we went through were very helpful to my understanding.
great
The homeworks and quizzes really set me up for the exams, giving us harder questions on the HWs for the exam to be a bit easier
going through R in class was a great exercise
The professor did a great job of breaking down every concept in the class, making it easy to follow.
It was helpful to work through problems and notes in class with Professor Bolfarine. Weekly quizzes helped as well.
I thought it was helpful that he posted the powerpoint slides for us to follow along with on our own
Running through the lesson on R helped me to visualize and understand what we learned
Amazing professor. He is very understanding of extenuating circumstances and has a very humorous teaching style. His compassion and understanding of the subject matter are two of my favorite things about him.
Walking through lectures and exercises through RStudio and actually having an in-class application of the material we learn.
I liked the slideshows, homeworks, and quizzes that reinforced the concepts I had learned in class.
He was so engaging and intentional with each student!
The most effective help were the quizzes as checks for understanding
Homework assignments aligned really well with the content of the class they were based on. This made them a good learning experience and way to practice testing the concepts.
Professor Bolfarine was incredibly knowledgeable, took on concepts from multiple angles and explained things thoroughly.
Professor Bolfarine is very good at keeping the class engaged with the class. He is always willing to help his students outside of class. He is an excellent instructor.
I think the class lectures and slides
code explanations, frq walk throughs
An aspect was how in depth the professor went when explaining examples and he always seemed to know the questions we were already thinking.
quizzes and homeworks
The aspects of the course that were most effective in my learning was the homeworks that we had to do weekly.
the video recordings
This class was amazing and was definitely an improvement from 301. I always struggled the most when it came to R, and the fact that Professor Bolfarine would spend so much time teaching us R code not only strengthened my confidence in the application of the code, but it also made me appreciate stats a lot more. I also appreciated the various materials he provided for each week (lecture recordings, lab recordings, etc.)
I enjoyed having additional study material prior to the exam, as well as our weekly quizzes as they reinforced me to stay up-to-date with the content. I think professor Bolfarine did a good job explaining any and all logistics towards the course whether that meant utilizing R studio or differing platforms.
Bolfarine walking and explaining the concepts through R studio and using #comments to describe what it shows and what he is doing
Very passionate professor who showed a lot of enthusiasm.
The lessons in class were helpful.
The study material for the exams
The Homework's and weekly quizzes
Did a very good job of explaining difficult concepts and being relatable at the same time.
positive attitude of the professor
he explained the material very well!!!!

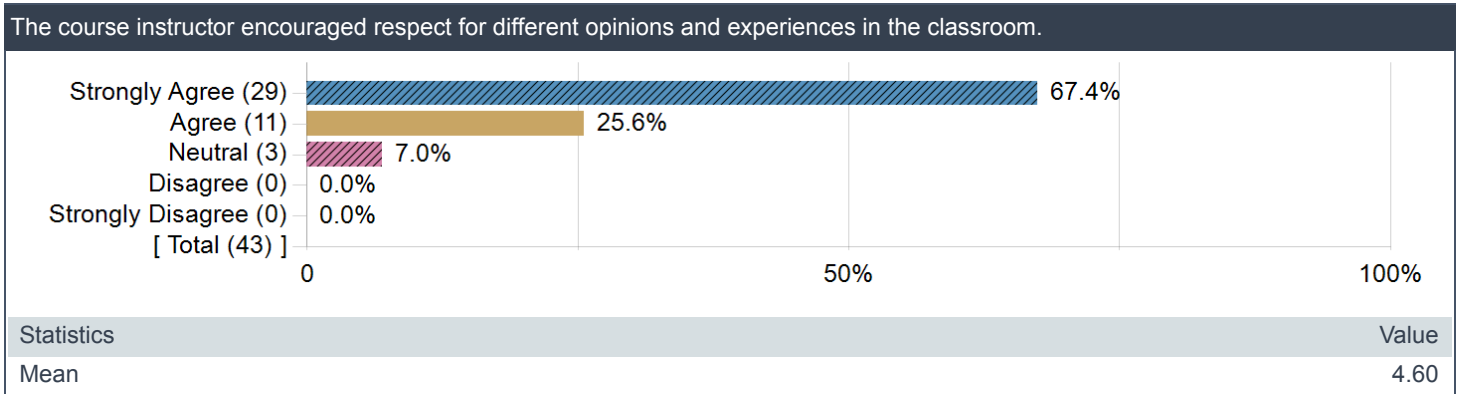
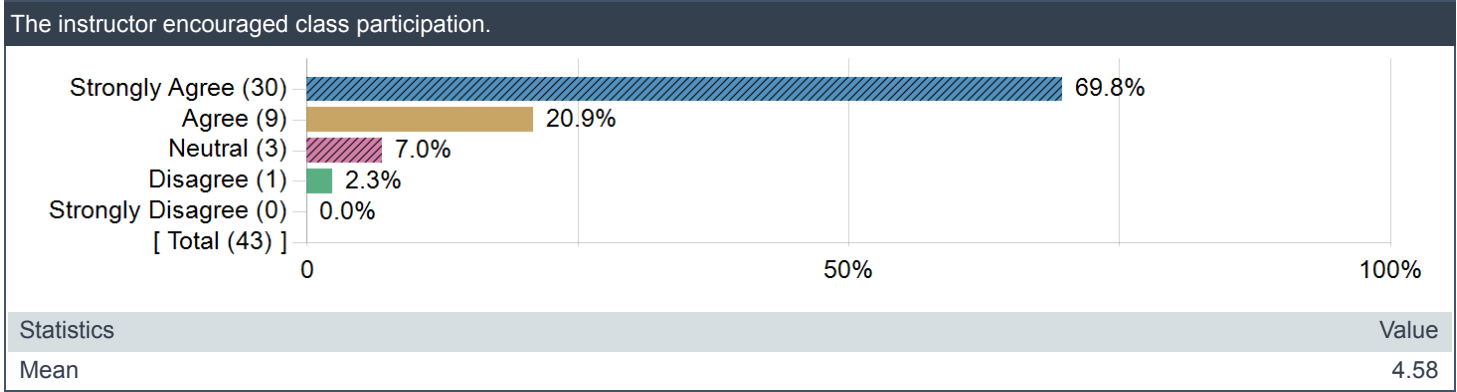
Comments
I enjoyed the active discussion based lectures. They ensured I was staying engaged and paying attention to the content.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The quizzes we had in the beginning of every class
– quizzes – exam
The most challenging part of this course were the quizzes and the fact that they took place every single week at the beginning of class and then participation was at the end of the class. It felt like a way to keep students there all class but really only encouraged selective participation.
I found the homework most challenging because I thought that some of the questions were very hard, and some of the questions would be on a homework before we went over it in class. I would suggest that students watch the lab videos that professor makes so that they know how to do every question.
Especially given the class start time, I felt that some of the class could have been more engaging in terms of asking questions to the class.
great
The Quizzes were slightly difficult sometimes and some covered things we didnt learn. I think some quizzes could have been a bit better if we were allowed to work with a partner
the wording could get confusing so i recommend to pay attention to the wording
The most challenging part of the course were the weekly quizzes are they required a lot of studying each week. However, I think that this is necessary to ensure students are caught up in the class.
The course content is already challenging in itself. This is because it involves interpreting data in ways that we haven't done before. The methods are complex. As long as students genuinely pay attention in class and do the homeworks, they should learn well.
I thought having to do the homework and textbook work and study for the quiz every week was a lot to manage sometimes with my other course work
I found the quizzes every class to be challenging, as it was hard to get consistent 100s on them and I felt they brought my grade down. Maybe doing a quiz once every two weeks to lengthen them out.
I think that some of the questions that we did in class/had on the quizzes could not replicate the difficulty of the test.
Sometimes the pace of the lectures felt very fast or rushed.
The exams were pretty challenging because they required you to truly understand the content and apply them in problems. One thing that could be done to help future students meet this challenge is to host more review sessions that cover the types of problems that are likely to be seen on the test.
The class lectures didn't help too much, quite a bit of outside work
The most challenging part of the course was also the quizzes. It was either you know it or you don't.
The textbook kind of sucked as it included the R code for concepts but didn't share the .csv files so students couldn't actually code alongside the textbook for a deeper understanding. I suggest reading the textbook carefully and copying code down on paper to help you remember it.
He would sometimes drag on about things we had already learned instead of diving into newer material.
I found the second unit much more difficult than the first one. The class examples were relatively easy, but the assignments quizzes were much more complicated. I think it would be helpful to go over more complicated problems during lecture.
The quizzes
frqs were challenging maybe spending more time on those
One aspect I found most challenging was working on word problems, and one thing that could be done to help with future students could be to do more practice with how to approach them.
exams keep up with homeworks and show up to lecture!
The aspect I found the most challenging were the quizzes as sometimes they would go over topics that were not included during the lecture. This can be fixed by just making sure the lecture time is used effectively.
r studio
Of course, the quizzes could be challenging to approach, especially with the amount of questions and their weightage on our grade, but it was also necessary for us to get the hit so we could be incentivized to learn the material before just the day of the exam
The most challenging were that certain components of the exam were not taught to us. More specifically being the open-ended portion of the exam. None of the STA 235 professors prepared us for these up until after the midterm Bolfarine realized how unprepared we were and provided additional practice and guidance. I also believe some classes didn't fully prepare us for the following weeks quiz as we would often learn up until the last minute or miss out on some parts of the lesson.

Comments
The quizzes in the beginning of class
Lot of complex ideas squished into one class per week.
The most challenging part are the exams. One thing that could be done is to use a different method for lockdown browser.
I overall just think it is a difficult class subject but if you took STA 301 somewhat seriously then STA 235 is not horrible
Keeping up with the notes with such a huge gap
The 8am wakeup... and the fact that it's just a difficult course.
Lockdown browser crashed during exam please find an alternative for this. ruined my grade for no reason.
content
I found the weekly quizzes challenging but they did aid my learning. Having to study every week was tedious but I felt I had to prepare less prior to the exams.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.